

ACTIVITY 10 — FACILITATOR GUIDE

Control Plan, A3 Summary, Handover, and Certification Readiness

TYPE	DURATION	DMAIC PHASE
Core Activity	60 min	CONTROL

Purpose of this activity

Recommend control actions to sustain process performance.

Hold the gain. Build a control plan that names the metric, the target, the monitoring frequency, the owner and the reaction plan — then tell the whole improvement story on a single A3 page and hand it over.

What learners produce

A control plan with a named owner and reaction plan on every row, a one-page A3 summary, a handover checklist and a personal certification readiness plan.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- A laptop with Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice Calc
- The CSV files in this activity's data/ and templates/ folders
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- The course slides for the scenario and the framework

Set-up

Groups of 3-5. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group. Every activity runs on the same continuous Contoso Service Desk scenario, so remind learners where this one sits in that story before starting.

Scenario / briefing material

Contoso Service Desk handles employee IT requests. Employees complain that tickets take too long to be assigned, that they must keep chasing for status, and that agents apply different definitions of what counts as "resolved". Handoffs between the front line and the specialist queues are unclear, and although ticket data exists it is inconsistent. You are supporting the improvement team as a Yellow Belt — you do not lead the project.

Two weeks of data have been collected: 400 tickets, of which 96 contained at least one defect, with 120 defects recorded in total across 6 defect opportunities per ticket. Mean assignment time is 55 minutes (median 46) against a 30-minute improvement goal. The CSV files in this activity's data/ folder are that extract.

Files in this activity folder

data/ — the mock data you analyse:

- assignment-times.csv — 400 rows (date, ticket_id, assignment_time_min)

templates/ — the worksheets you complete:

- a3-summary.csv (a3_section, content)
- control-plan.csv (process_step, metric, target, owner, check_frequency, response_plan)
- handover-checklist.csv (handover_item, accepted_by, date, notes)

Open these in Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice Calc. Work on a copy so the originals stay clean for revision.

Re-plot data/assignment-times.csv in NovaSPC to show the post-improvement position.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Create the control plan: metric, target, monitoring method, frequency, owner, reaction plan.	A control plan row without a named owner is not a control — it is a wish.
2	Define the visual management approach — board, dashboard or huddle — that keeps it visible.	Force the A3 onto one page; the discipline is the lesson.
3	Specify the reaction plan: exactly what happens when a metric falls outside target.	This is the last core lab — leave time to connect all ten outputs into one package.
4	Write the A3 summary: background, current state, goal, analysis, countermeasures, results, follow-up.	
5	Prepare the handover checklist so the process owner can sustain it without you.	
6	Complete your personal certification readiness plan — which topics need most review.	

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
15 min	Build the control plan
8 min	Define visual management
7 min	Specify the reaction plan
15 min	Write the A3 summary
10 min	Prepare the handover checklist
5 min	Complete the readiness plan

Total: 60 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. What happens, exactly, when the metric falls outside target — and who acts?
2. Could the process owner sustain this without you? What is missing?
3. Which topic do you most want to revisit after the course?

Debrief

Bring the class back together and draw out the learning:

- Ask two or three groups to show what they produced, not just what they concluded.
- Ask what surprised them — the gap between what they assumed and what the data showed.
- Link the activity explicitly back to the CONTROL phase of DMAIC.
- Remind learners how this activity feeds the next phase of the improvement package.

Reflection questions:

- What improvement at your workplace quietly decayed after the project ended?
- What control would have held it?

Facilitator notes — what to watch for

- A control plan row without a named owner is not a control — it is a wish.
- Force the A3 onto one page; the discipline is the lesson.
- This is the last core lab — leave time to connect all ten outputs into one package.

Success criterion

Every control plan row has a named owner and a reaction plan, and your A3 fits on one page.

How this fits the course

This activity builds the CONTROL phase of DMAIC. Every activity reuses the same techniques on the same Contoso Service Desk scenario and the same figures (400 tickets, yield 76%, DPMO 50,000), so the outputs accumulate into one improvement package. Nothing is practised here that is not taught in the slides.